



▲ KENTUCKY LONG RIFLE

Date 1840
Origin US
Barrel 44½in (113cm)
Caliber .46in (11.68mm)

This is a classic example of the American long rifle. The form of the butt and trigger guard were inspired by the shape of 18th-century sporting rifles made by immigrant German gunmakers, but the long barrel became a uniquely American feature.



▲ MOUSQUETON
D'ARTILLERIE MLE 1842

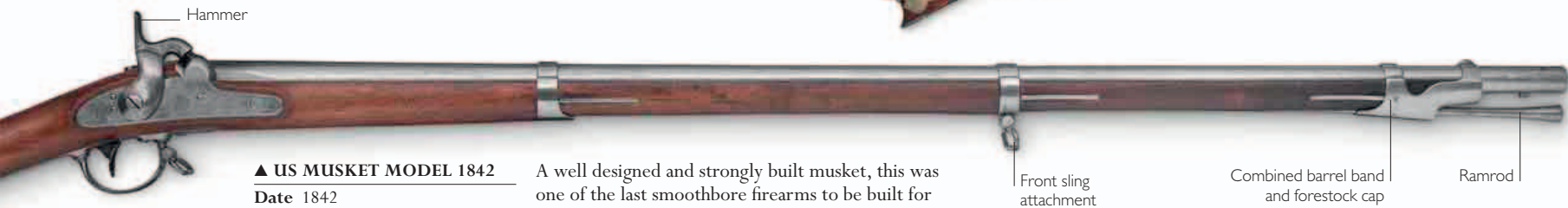
Date 1842
Origin France
Barrel 34in (86cm)
Caliber .71in (18mm)

First issued to the French Army 20 years earlier and subsequently modified to percussion ignition, the Modèle 1842 received improved rifling and detailed changes to the design of the hammer and nipple. It was produced in a variety of forms, but those for issue to artillerymen had 34-in (86-cm) long barrels, with two barrel bands.

▼ DOUBLE-BARRELED
PERCUSSION LONG RIFLE

Date 1845
Origin US
Barrel 33in (83.8cm)
Caliber .40in (10.16mm)

This rifle has the elegant lines of the Kentucky rifle (above) but has two barrels. It is built on the Wender system. In this system, the barrels could be rotated by hand. After the upper barrel had been fired, the lower one could be brought up to be fired in turn.



FULL VIEW

▲ US MUSKET MODEL 1842

Date 1842
Origin US
Barrel 44in (111.7cm)
Caliber .69in (17.52mm)

A well designed and strongly built musket, this was one of the last smoothbore firearms to be built for American troops before all infantry were issued with muzzle-loading rifles. Its design of lock and robust barrel bands would form the basis for new patterns of US military rifles.